Muncie Policy Memo

Civic Meeting Report

Unsafe Building November 12, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OA-pRY4nw_Q
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Unsafe Building Hearing Authority Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: November 12, 2026
Body: Unsafe Building Hearing Authority

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order:** The meeting was called to order at 00:00:59 by the presiding officer.
- **Authority Members Present:** Gretchen Cheeseman, John Lee, Mayor Dan Ridenower, James Heimck, and Jeff Green.
- **City Staff Present:** Taylor Reed, Melinda Coffee, Hannah Collins, Laura RH, Richard Rawlings (acting as administrators), and Courtney Walker (recording secretary).

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Participants stood and were sworn in collectively at 00:03:20 to give truthful testimony. The Unsafe Building Law (IC 36-7-9) was formally entered into the record 00:01:33.
- **Approval of Prior Minutes:** *(Not explicitly noted in transcript)*.

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:04:08 **Case No. 5 | 1010-1012 West Bethel Avenue ("The Cedars")**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dakota Crabtree (Middletown Property Group) & Hannah Collins (City Staff).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** City staff noted multiple structural, water damage, roof, and exterior issues across the complex buildings. The property representative reported that apartment door and ceiling repairs were completed, and requested 60 days to obtain exterior bids. A neighborhood representative (Sue Wland) expressed concern over general upkeep.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (rehab order affirmed, continued 60 days to January 14th hearing with a required inspection).
- 00:03:00 **Case No. 3 | 2411 East 22nd Street**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dakota Crabtree (Middletown Property Group).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Unit has a collapsed roof and water damage, vacant since September 14. Staff noted a roof replacement bid is approved. Board members questioned maintenance staffing levels; Crabtree reported the group is operating at its largest maintenance staff size since 2023.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (rehab order affirmed, continued 30 days with a required inspection).
- 00:12:08 **Case No. 4 | 1906 East 25th Street**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dakota Crabtree (Middletown Property Group).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed mildew ventilation, electrical panel labeling, window repair, and a tenant's makeshift duct-tape fix for hornets entering through gaps in the exterior wall. Management noted pest control is a tenant responsibility under the lease, but agreed to fix the structural gaps.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (rehab order affirmed, continued 30 days with a required inspection).
- 00:14:13 **Case No. 6 | 402 North Calvert Avenue, Apartment 5** *(Note: Corrected from Apartment 3)*
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dakota Crabtree (Middletown Property Group).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** The former tenant complained and moved out. A repair bid is approved for the vacant apartment, and 60 days were requested for exterior repairs, inclusive of interior water damage mitigation.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (rehab order affirmed, continued 60 days with a required inspection).
- 00:16:17 **Case No. 9 | 2001 East DePauw Avenue**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dakota Crabtree (Middletown Property Group).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Unit is vacant with approved bids for interior/exterior items. Bed bug treatments began November 3. Board members humorously and seriously addressed a "groundhog" trapped in the home, which management plans to trap

after bed bug eradication. Staff also requested proper basement access stairs be inspected.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (rehab order affirmed, continued 60 days with a required inspection).
- 00:18:47 **Case No. 10 | 3908 North Franklin Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dakota Crabtree (Middletown Property Group).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Replaced a leaking water heater, installed dehumidifiers, treated midges, and addressed a plumbing shut-off oversight by contractor Jackson Plumbing (which was quickly corrected). 30 days requested for balcony repairs.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (rehab order affirmed, continued 30 days with a required inspection).
- 00:20:31 **Case Nos. 7 & 8 | 5124 and 5112 North Canterbury Drive**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Gayen Roundtree (Canterbury Muny LLC).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed basement flooding, structural integrity, window sealing, egress stairs, and an initial no-heat issue in 5124 (resolved via portable heaters and afternoon repairs).
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (rehab order affirmed, continued 30 days with a required inspection for both units).
- 00:25:06 **Case No. 11 | 223 East Gilbert Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Bonita Smithers (Owner/Resident).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed foundation bricks, rotting fascia/porch wood, and overgrowth. Smithers noted she painted the house and complained about neighbor's gravel on a brick sidewalk and city sanitation not delivering requested trash cans.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (rehab order affirmed, continued 60 days with a required inspection prior to next hearing).
- 00:30:01 **Case No. 12 | 321-325 East Gilbert Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Lisa Brown (Owner).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Property has successfully completed repairs regarding gutters, holes, and debris.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (rehab order affirmed and case discharged/closed).
- 00:32:00 **Case No. 13 | 418 West Jackson Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sofia Goldstein (Owner) / Brandon Rodriguez (Former Tenant).
    - **Item-Specific Public Input** 00:34:45**:** Former tenant Brandon Rodriguez testified emotionally about severe negligence, mold, a window fall incident involving his daughter, loss of employment, and his children being placed in the care system.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Owner presented pest control invoices from Tri-County Pest Control and requested 60 days.

    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (rehab order affirmed, continued 60 days with an inspection prior to the next hearing).
- 00:38:38 **Case No. 15 | 1516 West Main Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dakota Crabtree (Middletown Property Group).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed exterior mortar cracks, wood rot, exposed wiring, and a failing retaining wall. Basement drain cleared. Tenant is negotiating a lease buyout notice.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (rehab order affirmed, continued 30 days with an inspection prior to the next hearing).
- 00:41:17 **Case No. 16 | 1913 North Maplewood Avenue**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** None present representing the owner. Neighborhood rep Sue Wland spoke.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Property tagged for shower leaks, subfloor rotting, cracked basement walls, missing GFCI outlets, foundation cracks, and garage disrepair while occupied by a tenant.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (rehab order affirmed, **civil penalty of $2,500 assessed for failure to appear**, and continued 30 days).
- 00:43:10 **Case No. 23 | 2201 East Willard Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Diana Grubs (Canterbury Muny LLC / Pest Control Business).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Commercial pest control building. Windows sealed, trash and vehicles removed. Asking for time to address a large garage door gap and high roof repairs.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (rehab and trash orders affirmed, continued 60 days with an inspection).
- 00:47:11 **Case No. 27 | 725 West Power Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Matthew Steen (Owner).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Steen acquired the property at tax sale in 2025, removed tons of trash, and structurally remodeled the exterior of the accessory garage. Zoned for variety business, no interior residential use.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (**demolition order modified to a rehab order**, and case discharged/closed due to compliance).
- 00:51:11 **Case No. 28 | 21101 East Purdue Road** *(Note: Address stated as Purdue)*
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Julio Munos (Owner).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Fire damage demo order. House is slated to be knocked down in 20 days. Owner reported challenges evicting a former tenant who continues living in a burnt camper on the property without paying rent.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (demo and trash order affirmed, continued 60 days with house demolition required and inspection prior to next hearing).
- 00:56:48 **Case No. 32 | 100 West First Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Walter Po (Owner).

    - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed roof leaks, foundation patches, and front steps. Owner requested 30 days to finish internal bathroom floor joist repairs.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (continued 30 days to December hearing with required inspection prior to hearing).
- 00:59:47 **Case No. 35 | 407 East 9th Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Steve Kelsey (Owner).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Owner took down dilapidated side stairs and the garage, repaired a basketball-sized roof hole caused by a birch tree, and secured aluminum siding gaps. Wants to sell the property. Board requested foundation slab cleanup.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (continued 30 days with inspection).
- **[00:5}:36] Case No. 47 | 1610 South Elm Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sherman Cook (Resident/Contract Buyer).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Cook explained that he bought the house on contract, but the record owner (who died on the way to the hospital) passed away before deed transfer. Board advised him to seek free legal aid at Maring-Hunt Library (first Tuesday of the month). Siding needs completion.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (continued 60 days focusing on siding completion, with inspection).
- 01:11:24 **Case No. 51 | 903 East Jackson Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Anna Meiser (Owner).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Vacant for roughly 40 years following a family member's departure and unexpected death of her husband. Property suffers from trespassing. Owner's daughter is currently negotiating potential sales with local and out-of-town buyers (including a historic society contact).
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (continued 30 days for sale status).
- 01:17:41 **Case No. 53 | 2022 South Jefferson Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Cody Wallace (Contractor/Representative).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Exterior repairs complete; awaiting final basement inspection sign-off.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (continued 30 days with inspection; case closes if passed).
- 01:19:15 **Case No. 54 | 1723 South Madison Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Lisa Brown (Owner).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Long-term rehab project. Exterior largely passes except handrail, brick work, and soffit. Interior electrical circuits running.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (continued 90 days to February 11th hearing with an inspection).
- 01:21:16 **Case No. 56 | 333 East North Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sofia Goldstein (Owner).

    - **Deliberation Summary:** Exterior window wrapping completed to prevent wood rot. Former tenant Tracy Daughter spoke out regarding past frustration with slum conditions.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (continued 30 days with an inspection scheduled for next week).
- 01:25:04 **Case No. 55 | 502 East Adams Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sofia Goldstein (Owner) / Tracy Green (Former Tenant).
    - **Item-Specific Public Input** 01:27:01**:** Former tenant Tracy Green spoke about fire damage loss, lack of renters insurance, and ongoing rent disputes. Board referred her to the Human Rights Commission.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Commercial/multi-unit building fire damage. Owner hired an architect to draft floor plans for state plan review submission.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (continued 90 days to February 11th with a permit and inspection required).
- 01:30:25 **Case No. 58 | 921 South Penn Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Andrea Edwards (Owner).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** New owner since September. Completed a new roof, new windows, and concrete door-base work. Preparing for masonry work and drywall insulation with the goal of opening a daycare by next August.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (continued 120 days to March 11th with inspection).
- 01:33:34 **Case No. 65 | 2808 Northwestwood Road**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dylan Kelly Hennis (Owner).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Property is under contract to sell to VSSN Acquisitions LLC, with closing scheduled for December 11. Owner paid off back taxes last month.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (continued to February 11th hearing).
- 01:37:06 **Golden Sky Properties Batch (Cases 67, 68, 69, 75)**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Joanne Bird (Golden Sky Management).
    - **Case 67 (716-718 W. Howard):** Heavy roach infestation required multiple pest control treatments. Tenants finally evicted. Needs extensive commercial/residential permits. Continued to March 11th with inspection (01:37:15).
    - **Case 68 (1117 E. Washington):** Work complete; awaiting final inspection 01:39:30. Continued 30 days.
    - **Case 69 (15 E. Willard):** Subfloor replaced, but minor differences with inspector notes need a 30-day resolution 01:40:22. Continued 30 days.
    - **Case 75 (209 North Manhattan):** Electrical issues addressed by a licensed electrician pulling a permit; tenant vacated. Continued 30 days with inspection 01:41:44.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** All approved by Voice Vote for respective continuances and inspections.

- 01:42:47 **Middletown Property Group Batch (Cases 70, 71, 72, 73, 74)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dakota Crabtree (Middletown Property Group).
  - **Case 70 (505 East 13th):** Permits pulled; contractor pivoting from Jefferson St. Continued 120 days to March 11th 01:42:57.
  - **Case 71 (720 West Centennial, Apt 42A):** Water damage, roaches, mice. Repairs delayed because tenant refuses entry unless present during narrow afternoon/weekend windows. Continued 60 days 01:44:31.
  - **Case 72 (1127 South Jefferson):** Interior gutted to studs, HVAC and electrical installed, drywall underway. Continued 60 days 01:48:52.
  - **Case 73 (1109 East Kirby, Unit 1):** Roof complete; awaiting mortar work vendor. Continued 30 days 01:50:56.
  - **Case 74 (21106 West Main, Apt B):** Basement cleared and decommissioned as storage. Garage roof replacement underway. Continued 30 days 01:52:13.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** All approved by Voice Vote for respective continuances.
- 01:39:56 **Case No. 78 | 526 North Bennett Street**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Lee Whitmer (Representing Owner/Daughter).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Land contract recorded. New windows and siding installed on the house. Shed has no foundation/door. Requesting 90 days as a solo worker.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (continued 90 days to February with an inspection).
- 01:56:41 **Case No. 84 | 422 West Howard Street**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Christian Peters (Owner).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Quadplex renovation. Secured funding, hired Midwest Exteriors LLC (Isaiah Blue), and applied for permits to rehab from studs out.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (continued 90 days to February with an inspection).
- 01:59:10 **Case No. 85 | 700 South Hoy Avenue**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Owner / Land Bank representative.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Land bank had a structural engineer evaluate the property. Building was recently broken into and ransacked. Meeting scheduled with the land bank next Monday to review options (rehab vs. demolition). Yard is mowed.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (continued 60 days to January).
- 02:02:02 **Case No. 91 (New Case) | 2000 East 29th Street, Lot 2 (Mobile Home Park)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John Jennings (Tenant).
  - **Item-Specific Public Input** 02:02:23**:** Tenant John Jennings testified that he and his wife both fell through rotted living room floorboards months apart. He detailed difficulties contacting the landlord, rent withholding confusion, code enforcement inspection on Nov 12, a subsequent 10-day pay-or-quit notice, and an upcoming eviction hearing on December 2.

    - **Deliberation Summary:** Board noted tenant-landlord lease disputes are outside their jurisdiction, but confirmed the mobile home cannot be re-rented in its hazardous condition.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (rehab order affirmed, continued 30 days).
- 02:10:53 **Added Agenda Item | 649 South Madison Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Phil Tavis (Tro Land Company).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Added to the agenda at the owner's request due to scheduling conflicts in January. Owner removed the western half of the commercial structure years ago and recently removed the facade using an MRC grant, discovering an unforeseen structural issue with a failing masonry lintel over the garage door. Seeking time to evaluate stabilization versus demolition quotes.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition: Motion to add to agenda approved by Voice Vote.** Subsequently, demolition order affirmed and **continued to March 11th** by Voice Vote.
- 02:21:30 **Case No. 77 | 809 West 9th Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff Bruwell (Owner).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Owner demolished the original house, brought in a modular home, bolted and secured foundation "cookies," repaired termite damage and reframed a 4-car garage, and cleared property debris.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (**demolition order modified to a rehab order**, continued to March 11th).
- 02:24:49 **Case No. 82 | 1135 South High Street**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Pam Harlon Dashtrot (Owner).
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Fire-damaged property. Owner contacted Habitat for Humanity (Ryan Payant) but received no clear response. Multiple purchase offers received, including one from a neighboring construction owner (Hang Your Hat LLC).
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (continued 30 days with a required decision on sale or demolition).

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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(Note: Public comments were integrated directly into specific property hearings throughout the docket, featuring testimony from tenants and neighbors such as Sue Wland, Brandon Rodriguez, Tracy Daughter, Tracy Green, and John Jennings).

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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Announcements:** Reminders given regarding legal aid availability at Maring-Hunt Library (first Tuesday of every month from 10:00 AM to 1:00 PM). Inspection scheduling protocols and $150 penalties for missing pre-hearing inspections were reiterated.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting concluded following the final case review. *(Exact official adjournment time not explicitly stated in transcript)*.

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